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Best practices for choosing user roles

Updated 8 months ago

Overview

All users in a Fireblocks workspace require an assigned role. [User roles](#) grant permissions regarding which parts of the platform users can access, what type of actions they can perform, and whether they have MPC key shares used to sign transactions.

You can assign users the following roles:

- Owner
- Admin
- Non-Signing Admin
- Signer
- Approver
- Editor
- Viewer

The Owner, Admin, and Signer roles have an MPC key share and can sign transactions. Assign these roles carefully using the [Principle of Least Privilege](#) to maximize your workspace security.

The Non-Signing Admin, Editor, Approver, and Viewer roles do not require MPC shares and cannot sign transactions. However, Non-Signing Admins, Editors, and Approvers can initiate transactions if you assign a designated signer. Non-Signing Admins and Approvers can also approve transactions.

Admin Quorum vs. Policies

Before defining user roles, we recommend understanding the difference between the [Admin Quorum](#) and [Policies](#). While the Admin Quorum is responsible for approving workspace configuration changes and defining the whitelisted space to which funds can

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Using Policies, you can set up approvals for transactions that must be met before users are prompted to sign the transactions.

Only Admins and the Owner can participate in the Admin Quorum, while Policies may apply to all workspace users except Viewers. Only the Admins and the Owner can participate in both the Admin Quorum and the Policies. Some workspace actions require the Owner's approval in the Admin Quorum, while other actions can be approved with only Admins.

Consider vacations and leaves of absence when defining the Admin Quorum threshold and the number of approvals required in the Policy. Transactions that require the approval of all users in a group may be delayed until users return from vacation or leave.

Workspace Owner

The workspace Owner is the root user of a workspace and is responsible for approving multi-party computation (MPC) signing devices and new users, in addition to all other Admin privileges. Every workspace requires only one Owner to set up the Fireblocks Vault.

For security purposes, the Owner role is automatically assigned to the respective user by Fireblocks Support. To [change the Owner](#) of a workspace, or when the Owner wants to [change their role, migrate to a new mobile device](#), or unfreeze the workspace, the Owner must first verify their identity with Fireblocks Support by scheduling a short video call.

The Owner's recommended responsibilities are:

- Approving new signing devices and MPC key shares
- Approving new workspace users
- Approving new external connections
- Creating API keys
- Deleting workspace users
- Enabling advanced workspace features
- Creating, editing, and approving workspace policies
- Resetting two-factor authentication (2FA)
- Enacting emergency operations like freezing the workspace, creating a backup kit, and recovery

Important

If you are the only user in a workspace who can sign transactions, we recommend creating additional Admin or Signer users as a precautionary measure. This helps to

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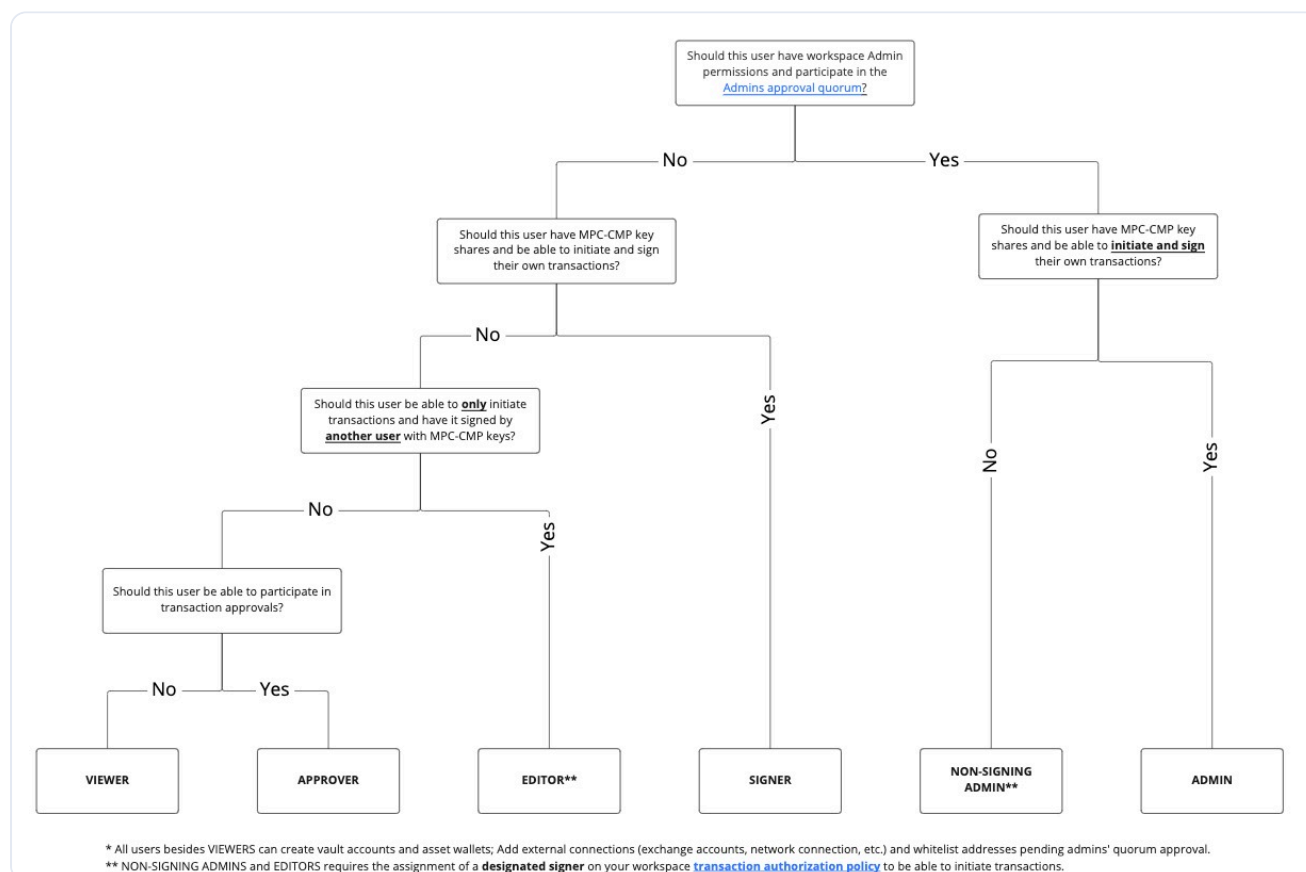
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Choosing user roles

The following questions and answers can help you determine the appropriate user roles for your Fireblocks users.

Do you want the user to:

- Receive an MPC key share and be able to sign transactions? If yes, choose Admin or Signer.
- Receive access to Fireblocks workspace configuration and external connection approval, and be able to freeze the workspace? If yes, choose Admin or Non-Signing Admin.
- Only be able to initiate transactions? If yes, choose Editor. Note that transactions initiated by an Editor must be signed by a designated signer. Designated signers are defined in the Policy and must have signing privileges. [Learn more about designated signers](#).
- Be able to approve transactions? If yes, choose Approver.
- Receive access for auditing purposes only? If yes, choose Viewer.



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